

Personal appearance and appearances via ZOOM are available.

Probate Calendar for Friday, July 17, 2026

9:00 a.m. in Department Paso 2, with Judge Michael C. Kelley presiding

No.	Case Number	Case Name	Type of Matter	Probate Notes
<u>The following matters are OFF CALENDAR/ DISMISSED/ TERMINATED or CONTINUED:</u>				
2	14PR-0274	Guardianship of: Brianna Spicer	Petition Third & Final Account Filed 10/31/2025	CONTINUED LIST: <i>The matter is continued to October 23, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional information must be filed by September 18, 2026. The following is noted:</i> <i>Ending balance on Hand.</i> <i>Additional information is needed as to how some of the share amounts were calculated. The Court is unable to duplicate the shares owned based on the information provided for CAIBX, ABALX, AMECX, AIVSX. The Raymond James account share values on the Change In Form assets schedule are not isolated per fund. The Petitioner should reorganize and check all of the share values on those six stocks. Please see the Fiduciary Accounting Handbook (CEB), Auxiliary Schedules, section 12.19.1 Form: Purchase of Bond and Reimbursement of Dividend for a sample of how to show the running total of the stock shares owned.</i> <i>Further review will be needed once the above issues are resolved.</i>
<u>APPROVED LIST</u>				

1	14PR-0082	In Re: Barbara Linda Ware Special Needs Trust	Petition Fifth Account Filed 12/04/2025	APPROVED LIST: <i>The matter is recommended for approval, subject to the following:</i> <i>1. The total bond of \$123,700 is recommended. Bond is currently set and posted at \$116,307.35. This results in a bond increase of \$7,392.65. An OSC re: Increased bond is set for October 30, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2.</i> <i>2. The Court Account review fee of \$305.00 is due.</i> <i>3. The Sixth Account, for the period of October 1 2025 to September 30, 2027 is due by January 5, 2028.</i>
<u>HEARING LIST</u>				
3	20PR-0014	Conservatorship of: John Lindquist	Petition Second Account & Report Filed 11/07/2025	<i>Still under review.</i>
4	20PR-0309	Conservatorship of: Robert Brenna	Petition First Year Account; cont'd 9/13/24, 3/14/25, 5/30/25, 9/19/25 and 3/13/26 (SIXTH HRG)	HEARING LIST: <i>Zoom or personal appearance is needed. The Court has continued this matter multiple times, the last time on March 13th to this date, July 17, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. in P2. Additional materials were due by June 1, 2026. An Amended Inventory was filed, with the corrected start date and a new starting balance, but the Amended Account has still not been provided.</i> <i>1. Accounting issues:</i> <i>a. The account start date should have been from April 23, 2021, the date when the conservatorship was ordered in Court. (See Fiduciary Accounting Handbook (Cont.Ed.Bar 2024) When The Accounts of Guardians and Conservators Begin, § 5.4.a.) An amended Account is needed.</i> <i>b. Financial statements have not been located as alleged. (Prob. Code, §2620.)</i>

				c. <i>Original statements from the care facility located under Schedule C are needed and were not located. (Prob. Code, §2620.) Supporting statements are also needed for those items alleged in the liability schedule, which are not requested for payment from the Conservatorship (Sunrise Terrace and Shiloh Green Manor II).</i> d. <i>Additional information is needed on the \$140,921.51 as alleged liability due to the Petitioner from the conservatorship. A large portion of the itemized costs provided are from a year prior to the appointment and up to six (6) months prior to the filing of this case. Legal authority is needed for payment of the alleged amounts, along with additional information as to why this liability was incurred far before this Court had jurisdiction, in April of 2020. Particular attention should be paid to the following liability requests:</i> i. <i>Original statements are needed from the care facilities, as noted above. The Conservatorship estate is now being asked to pay for the same,</i> ii. <i>Itemized statements are needed from Tardiff Law firm, whose fees are now being requested to be paid by the conservatee.</i> iii. <i>Information is needed on the VCCU credit card.</i> iv. <i>Additional information is needed on the \$3,893.29 in interest incurred on the Discover credit card. Whose name is on the card and why was the credit card not paid off each</i>
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				month? Why was such interest allowed to incur, including over \$500 in interest on pre-paid legal fees paid to the Tardiff Law firm. and items purchased after the conservatorship was established, including but not limited to over \$300 on the bond premium? The practice of putting conservatorship expenses on a credit card, and then over \$3,000 in interest being incurred due to unpaid totals each month on said credit card is very concerning and does not appear to be in line with fiduciary standards. e. A revised schedule describing the change in the form of assets is needed. It is unclear from the materials presented and the current Change in the Form of Asset Schedule, how the total ending shares number and carry value were determined for the three mutual funds on hand 2. Attorney fees: a. The paralegal rate requested exceeds the community standard. A reduction of the fee is recommended in the amount of \$1,417. b. It is recommended the charges related to the “ex parte motion/petition to change venue” be denied. The benefit to the estate for this particular filing is not clear, especially because the conservatee has not returned to Ventura County, but rather, is now in Sonoma County. A reduction of \$2,697.50 is recommended. This does incorporate the reduction of the hourly rate for the paralegal fee noted in 6.a.
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				<i>c. The cost of preparing this account appears high at over \$7,700.00. Additional information is needed to explain the overall process and sum incurred. In addition, specific information is needed on how much time was incurred in preparing the liability schedule and interest schedule related to the Petitioner's current reimbursement request.</i> <i>3. Additional Liability-</i> <i>a. It does not appear the fee due to Attorney Pick, ordered on May 11, 2022, has been paid per the account. This sum was not listed as an outstanding liability. Counsel charged to attend the hearing on 5/6/22, so it appears all parties were aware of the approval.</i> <i>4. The Court Account Review fee of \$305 is due.</i>
5	20PR-0309	Conservatorship of: Robert Brenna	Order to Show Cause re: Second Year Accounting; cont'd 3/14/25, 5/30/25, 9/19/25, 3/13/26	HEARING LIST: <i>The Court has continued this OSC five times. It is unclear why nothing has been filed.</i>
6	20PR-0309	Conservatorship of: Robert Brenna	Order to Show Cause re Sanctions re: failure to respond to probate notes	HEARING LIST: <i>Zoom or personal appearance is required. Sanctions of \$500.00 are recommended for the continued failure to file a meaningful response to the First Account notes or the missing Second and Final Account.</i>
7	21PR-0074	Conservatorship of: Richard Ratledge	Petition Fourth Account & Report Filed 12/24/2025	<i>Still under review.</i>
8	22PR-0103	Guardianship of: Natalie Seybold	Petition Third Account Filed 1/08/2026	<i>Still under review.</i>
9	22PR-0179	Guardianship of: Shania Jefferies	Petition First Account Filed 1/09/2026	<i>Still under review.</i>

10	22PR-0179	Guardianship of: Shania Jefferies	Petition Second Account Filed 1/09/2026	<i>Still under review.</i>
11	23PR-0364	Conservatorship of: Nona Crist	Petition First & Final Account Filed 1/07/2026	<i>Still under review.</i>
12	24PR-0164	Conservatorship of: Andrea Kern	Petition First & Final Account Filed 12/01/2025	<i>Still under review.</i>
13	PR24686	Conservatorship Of: Michael Santos	Petition Fourteenth Account & Report Filed 11/19/2025	<i>Still under review.</i>
14	PR050143	Conservatorship of: Maria Gutierrez	Petition re: Ninth Account Filed 8/01/2025; Cont'd 3/13/26	<i>Still under review.</i>
15	20PR-0275	Guardianship of: Krew Sims-Pierce	Petition Filed 10/30/2024 - Confidential Hearing; Cont'd 6/26/25, 8/22/25, 10/24/25 & 2/27/26	HEARING LIST: <i>Zoom or personal appearance is needed. The parties indicated at the hearing on February 27, 2026 that the matter has settled, but nothing has been filed. This was repeated at the hearing on July 10th when the matter was short set to this date. Again, nothing has been filed.</i>

Subject to the rules below, attorneys and parties to a case may now contact the Probate Research Department using the following email: probate@slo.courts.ca.gov.

The following rules apply to use of the foregoing email address. An email that does not comply with the requirements below may not be reviewed.

1. Emails must be related only to a Probate Note (past or present).
 - a. The following exceptions apply: (1) A party or attorney has specifically received an email from the Court on an issue requiring response; or (2) the Court directed an email be sent to the Probate Research Department (Examples: Solicited email from a bench officer or a Court Attorney or information ordered to be provided via email by bench officer in Court).
2. **Emails must contain:**
 - a. **Subject Line: Hearing Date, Time, Department, Case Number and Case Name (Example: 10/1/19, 9:00, D99, 18PR0000, Estate of John Smith).**

- b. First Line of Email Body: Case Number, Case Name, and Description of the pleading on the calendar.**
- c. Reason for Request.**
- d. No Attachments.**

3. Further, email inquiries must conform to the following guidelines:

- a. Questions must be from an attorney or party on the case.
- b. The Court's response after the initial reply is limited to one email message per calendar matter, per hearing.
- c. The body of the email (Reason for Request under item 2.c.) is limited to (5) lines to each deficiency or issue.
- d. Emails may only inquire into clarifications regarding the Probate Note. This includes clarifying language, code sections, court rules and policies related to the Probate Note. Disputes regarding requirements or issues raised in the Probate Note may not be made via email.
- e. Emails advising the Court of possible oversights may be sent.
- f. Continuances may not be requested via the probate email address.**

4. This email procedure is NOT to be utilized for:

- a. Any requests for legal advice (including, but not limited to, how to clear the Probate Note), case management, and/or a recommendation for an attorney.
- b. Confirmation of documents received by the Court. Please refer to the conformed copy of your filed document to confirm the Court's receipt. If you have not received a conformed copy of your document, please contact the Civil Clerk's Office.
- c. Confirmation that documents have been reviewed.

5. Response Time. All correspondence will be addressed on a priority basis according to the hearing date. The Probate Research Department will make every effort to respond within two Court days of receipt of the email.